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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 2 : Session – 9 | Towards a Humanistic World-view

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. The PREVAILING view of society's goal: unlimited economic growth and consumption — progress measured by GDP, technology and accumulation. ACHIEVEMENTS: remarkable science, connectivity, medicine, material comfort for many. SIDE-EFFECTS: widening inequality, exploitation of people and nature, resource depletion, pollution and climate crisis, broken families, stress and loneliness — material expansion without human fulfilment.
2. Q2. Technology has physically connected the planet into a 'global village' — but a CONNECTION of bodies/markets without a WORLD-VIEW of co-existence simply exports the local mindset of accumulation globally: stronger parties exploit weaker ones at planetary scale, resources are extracted across borders, and waste is dumped on the unseen. Physical proximity without the feeling of relationship turns connectivity into a more efficient machinery of exploitation.
3. Q3. Two essential requirements of a global world-view: (1) RIGHT UNDERSTANDING — seeing existence as co-existence, units submerged in the larger order, hence every unit's fulfilment lying in mutual fulfilment; (2) the FEELING of relationship with every human being and with nature — a sense of the whole human family and of nature as our extended body. Understanding gives clarity; feeling gives the motivation to act for all.
4. Q4. The proposal: LOCALISE production and consumption of basic physical needs — food, water, energy, shelter, education, health — so communities are self-reliant and accountable to their own ecosystems; GLOBALISE understanding, values, knowledge, science and feelings — so the whole humanity shares one humanistic world-view. Reason: physical systems are sustainable when scaled to local ecosystems, while harmony requires universal, borderless understanding and trust.
5. Q5. IS THERE A SOLUTION? Yes — the film and the localise/globalise idea show the direction: problems like inequality, ecological damage and conflict are outcomes of a fragmented world-view, so the solution is a shift to a HUMANISTIC, co-existential world-view — right understanding and right feeling in every individual, self-reliant local communities, and universal human values shared globally. My view: technology and policy help only when this inner transformation accompanies them; education for human values is therefore the real starting point.